

Acne Studios

AGENDA

A. Context Analysis

Brand snapshot

Identity

Category and market frame

Competitive Landscape

Brand asset and channels

Target

Customer journey

PESTEL

SWOT

Key challenge and opportunities

4+3 P

B. Brand extension

LAGOM

The concept

Location strategy

Estimated costs

Communication strategy

Context

Analysis



BRAND SNAPSHOT

- Scandinavian-rooted aesthetic with art and design authority
- Strong equity built on silhouette, materials, and visual identity
- DTC presence supports brand control and consistency

"Acne Studios is a contemporary luxury brand defined by minimalism, cultural capital, and product credibility."



Identity

Codes

Clean lines, neutral palette, understated yet distinctive details. The aesthetic is rooted in Scandinavian minimalism but twisted with artistic subversion

Tone

Cultured, understated, contemporary. The brand speaks through product and imagery rather than loud slogans. Intellectual yet accessible

Recognition

Comes from design language, not overt branding. The "Face" motif and specific color palette (Pink) serve as subtle but powerful identifiers

CATEGORY & MARKET FRAME

The category is moving toward 'quiet luxury,' intentional consumption, and lifestyle adjacencies

The growth of **elevated essentials** reflects a shift away from logo-first propositions toward understated, design-driven products.

Consumers increasingly prioritise **durability, craft,** and overall brand coherence, valuing long-term quality over overt branding.

For brands like Acne Studios, this means focusing on strong **design codes** and consistent aesthetic identity.

Moreover, **lifestyle** extensions succeed only when they protect core brand codes and maintain a sense of **scarcity**, avoiding overexposure or dilution.



COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

Direct Competitors

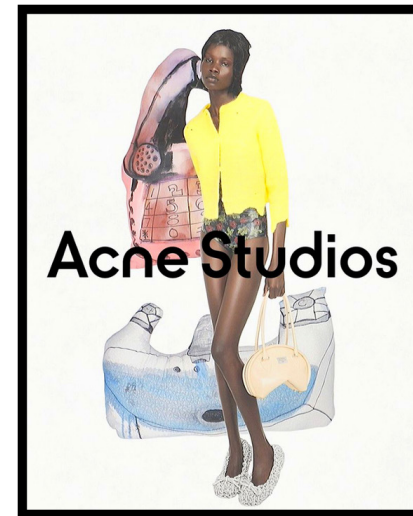
Its direct competitors belong to the contemporary premium segment — brands that are strongly driven by design excellence and cultural relevance, building their identity around a distinctive and recognizable creative language.

Adjacent Set

At the same time, Acne also competes with players in the luxury segment — aspirational brands characterized by high price points and strong symbolic value.

Implication

Within this competitive context, the strategic priority is to protect brand distinctiveness while increasing frequency of engagement, strengthening its relevance as a lifestyle-driven brand.







BRAND ASSET & CHANNELS

*Acne already owns the channels
needed for full funnel performance.*

Social

Storytelling + community + cultural
positioning

E-commerce

Conversion + editorial product edu-
cation + data capture

Retail

Experiential reinforcement of pre-
mium perception

Fewer, better choices. White space for premium...

*"The target seeks calm, meaning,
and curation in an overstimulated
environment"*

...functional objects. Rituals & aesthetic consistency



T A R G E T

Core Target

Profile

Urban, fashion-aware, design/culture driven, premium-minded.

They seek cultural belonging and “in-the-know” status.

Drivers

Aesthetics, quality cues, cultural credibility, low-noise brand

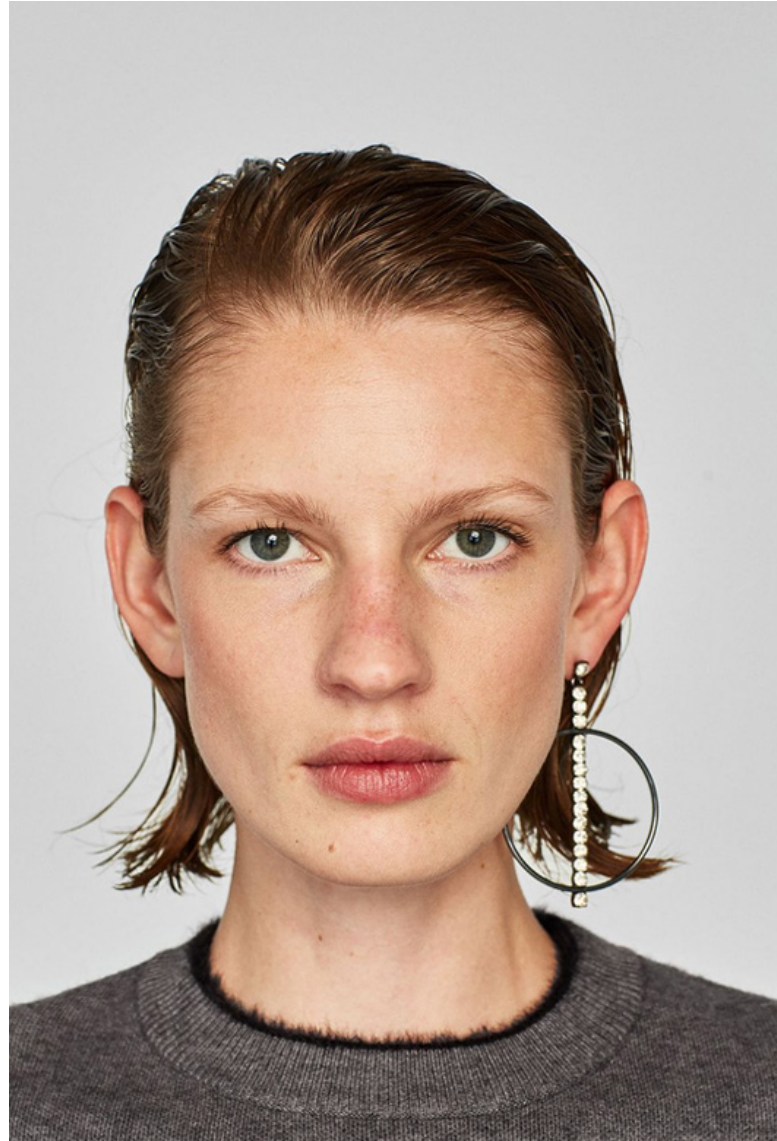
Growth Target

Profile

Quiet-luxury adopters seeking credible everyday premium. They value utility and longevity over trends.

Drivers

Utility, comfort, longevity, understated premium, practical value



PERSONA 1 - THE URBAN CURATOR

City-based creative professional with a minimalist, contemporary style. Invests in premium, well-designed pieces that reflect authenticity and cultural credibility. Avoids mainstream brands and editorial content.
Touchpoints: Instagram, editorials, concept stores, curated e-commerce.

"Buys selectively and values aesthetic coherence"

PERSONA 2 - THE PREMIUM MINIMALIST



Aware of his need for a new denim piece aligned with his identity. Compares premium brands, focusing on silhouette, materials and durability. Chooses the brand that offers superior design and coherent storytelling. **Post-purchase, becomes loyal and engages with capsules**

"Buys selectively and values aesthetic coherence"

CUSTOMER JOURNEY

The plan must guide discovery - Desirability - Conversation - Retention

AWARENESS

Creators + PR/
editorials
Social storytelling

CONSIDERATION

Materials/function
proof
Styling, editorial

PURCHASE

Drops + DTC
convenience
Retail touchpoints

LOYALTY

CRM, community
Repeat-worthy
products



PESTLE

***POLITIC**

***ECONOMIC**

***SOCIAL & CULTURAL**

***TECHNOLOGICAL**

***LEGAL**

***ENVIRONMENTAL**

PESTLE

*POLITIC

*ECONOMIC

*SOCIAL & CULTURAL

*TECHNOLOGICAL

*LEGAL

*ENVIRONMENTAL

Trade regulations

Geopolitical tensions

Labor laws

As a **global brand**, Acne Studios is influenced by **international trade regulations** and agreements between the EU, US and Asia. **Geopolitical tensions** may impact **supply chains** and logistics costs, while **EU labor laws** affect operational expenses and retail management.

PESTLE

*POLITIC

***ECONOMIC**

*SOCIAL & CULTURAL

*TECHNOLOGICAL

*LEGAL

*ENVIRONMENTAL

Economic cycles

Raw material costs

Currency fluctuations

The brand is sensitive to economic cycles, as luxury spending fluctuates with consumer purchasing power. Variations in raw material costs and currency exchange rates directly influence production margins and global pricing strategies.

PESTLE

*POLITIC

*ECONOMIC

***SOCIAL & CULTURAL**

*TECHNOLOGICAL

*LEGAL

*ENVIRONMENTAL

Sustainability demand Minimal aesthetics Digital consumption

Consumers increasingly value sustainability, transparency and ethical production. The global appreciation for minimal and Scandinavian aesthetics reinforces the brand identity, while shopping habits are shifting toward e-commerce, resale platforms and capsule collections.

PESTLE

*POLITIC

*ECONOMIC

*SOCIAL & CULTURAL

***TECHNOLOGICAL**

*LEGAL

*ENVIRONMENTAL

E-commerce innovation Supply chain digitalization Social media

Technological innovation enhances the digital retail experience through advanced e-commerce and immersive tools. Digitalized supply chains improve traceability and transparency, while social media platforms are essential for storytelling and brand positioning.

PESTLE

*POLITIC

*ECONOMIC

*SOCIAL & CULTURAL

*TECHNOLOGICAL

***LEGAL**

*ENVIRONMENTAL

Sustainability compliance

Intellectual property

Data protection

Stricter EU sustainability regulations require greater traceability and control over green claims. Protecting intellectual property is crucial in a counterfeiting-prone sector, while data protection laws (GDPR) shape e-commerce and CRM practices.

PESTLE

*POLITIC

*ECONOMIC

*SOCIAL & CULTURAL

*TECHNOLOGICAL

*LEGAL

***ENVIRONMENTAL**

Carbon emissions

Responsible sourcing

Climate change

The industry faces growing pressure to reduce carbon emissions and improve sustainable sourcing. Acne Studios invests in responsible materials, recycling and waste reduction, while climate change impacts raw material availability and collection planning.

SWOT

INTERNAL	STRENGTH: - International cult brand with strong creative and cultural identity. - Global presence with iconic flagship stores. - Integrated brand storytelling across art, design and publications. - B Corp certified sustainability as an ESG lever.	WEAKNESS: - Not traditionally associated with hospitality, risking initial perception misalignment. - High price positioning and operational costs in premium locations. - Need for careful operational planning in a new sector. - Balancing sustainability integration with premium pricing.
EXTERNAL	OPPORTUNITIES: - Expansion of immersive retail experiences in flagship stores. - Growing demand for integrated cultural and culinary experiences. - Strategic partnerships with authentic food & beverage players.	THREATS: - Competition from other luxury brands entering café/lifestyle concepts. - Regulatory barriers in the food & beverage sector. - Market saturation of store/café lifestyle concepts in major cities.

KEY CHALLENGE & OPPORTUNITIES

CHALLENGE

Expanding beyond seasonal fashion moments while remaining authentically “Acne.” The brand must avoid dilution and overexposure in an increasingly crowded market, ensuring that any extension feels coherent with its creative identity and cultural positioning.

OPPORTUNITY

A lifestyle extension aligned with calm functionality and the brand’s design-driven ethos. This responds to the growing consumer desire for curated living — experiences and products that integrate aesthetics, purpose, and everyday ritual in a seamless way.

SOLUTION

Lagom by Acne — a curated, design-led, and repeatable concept. A natural evolution of the brand codes, translating Acne’s creative language into a lifestyle dimension while preserving its distinctiveness.

SMART OBJECTIVES

REVENUE

€12.5M

Generate incremental revenue from the Lagom collection launch in key markets.

SELL-THROUGH

70%+

Maintain high full-price sell-through to avoid discounting and brand dilution.

BRAND EQUITY

+15%

Increase brand consideration among the "Growth Target" segment.

ACQUISITION

5.000

New customers acquired through the Lagom entry-point category.



KPI FRAMEWORK

AWARENESS

Reach & Impressions

Total campaign visibility across social channels and PR, measuring how widely the initiative spreads and how effectively it captures attention.

Brand Sentiment

Volume of positive mentions and strength of cultural association, indicating how the brand is perceived and discussed within relevant communities.

ENGAGEMENT

Engagement Rate

Likes, shares, saves, and other high-value interactions that signal active interest rather than passive exposure.

Time on Site

Depth of content consumption on PDPs, reflecting how strongly users connect with the narrative and explore the offering.

CONVERSION

Sell-Through Rate

Percentage of inventory sold at full price, demonstrating demand strength and pricing power.

AOV (Average Order Value)

Increase in basket size driven by cross-selling and product pairing strategies.

LOYALTY

Retention Rate

Percentage of customers returning within six months, indicating sustained relevance beyond the initial purchase.

CLV (Customer Lifetime Value)

Growth in long-term customer value, reflecting the brand's ability to build enduring relationships.

4+3P

- * PRODUCT
- * PRICE
- * PROMOTION
- * PLACE

- * PEOPLE
- * PROCESS
- * PHYSICAL EVIDENCE



4+3P

*** PRODUCT**

*** PRICE**

*** PROMOTION**

*** PLACE**

*** PEOPLE**

*** PROCESS**

*** PHYSICAL EVIDENCE**

Acne Studios offers a highly recognizable product proposition characterized by:

- Clean, architectural silhouettes inspired by Nordic design
- High-quality materials (premium denim, leather, fine wool)
- Minimal yet experimental design approach
- Distinctive iconic pieces (e.g., 1996 jeans, oversized footwear)
- A positioning within the contemporary luxury segment, driven by strong aesthetic and cultural value

4+3P

* PRODUCT

* **PRICE**

* PROMOTION

* PLACE

* PEOPLE

* PROCESS

* **PHYSICAL EVIDENCE**

Acne Studios adopts a premium pricing strategy characterized by:

- High price levels aligned with contemporary luxury brands
- Value-based pricing reflecting design, quality, and brand image
- Limited and controlled promotional discounts
- Objective: preserve exclusivity and high perceived value

4+3P

* PRODUCT

* PRICE

* **PROMOTION**

* PLACE

* PEOPLE

* PROCESS

* **PHYSICAL EVIDENCE**

The brand follows a curated and selective communication strategy:

- Minimalist visual communication aligned with brand identity
- Artistic, unconventional campaigns
- Strong social media presence with editorial tone
- Creative collaborations with artists and photographers
- Experiential boutique events in key fashion capitals

4+3P

* **PRODUCT**

* **PRICE**

* **PROMOTION**

* **PLACE**

* **PEOPLE**

* **PROCESS**

* **PHYSICAL EVIDENCE**

Acne Studios adopts a selective distribution strategy to preserve its premium positioning:

- Flagship boutiques in key global cities
- Highly curated proprietary e-commerce platform
- Limited selection of high-end retailers
- Scandinavian-inspired minimalist store design

4+3P

* **PRODUCT**

* **PRICE**

* **PROMOTION**

* **PLACE**

* **PEOPLE**

* **PROCESS**

* **PHYSICAL EVIDENCE**

People play a key role in delivering the Acne Studios experience:

- Sales staff trained to provide consultative, non-intrusive service
- Creative direction ensuring aesthetic coherence
- International, design-conscious clientele reinforcing cultural positioning

4+3P

* **PRODUCT**

* **PRICE**

* **PROMOTION**

* **PLACE**

* **PEOPLE**

* **PROCESS**

* **PHYSICAL EVIDENCE**

Operational processes are designed for aesthetic coherence and efficiency:

- Seamless online and in-store experience
- Quality-focused production processes
- Premium customer service
- Consistent and refined brand communication

4+3P

* **PRODUCT**

* **PRICE**

* **PROMOTION**

* **PLACE**

* **PEOPLE**

* **PROCESS**

* **PHYSICAL EVIDENCE**

Physical evidence reinforces the brand's premium identity through:

- Iconic, art-inspired store design
- Elegant packaging
- Tangible product quality and craftsmanship
- Website and visual materials reflecting the brand's sophisticated DNA

BRAND EXTENSION

LAGOM

WHAT IS LAGOM?...

*"Lagom" is a Swedish word with no exact translation in English. It means **"just enough,"** balance, harmony, and moderation.*

Lagom by Acne is a cultural café integrated within the Acne Studios flagship.

combining specialty coffee, a live creative atelier, and a small exhibition area. It is a philosophy that places time, quality, and sustainability at the center. By translating this cultural principle into a café format, Acne Studios transforms a simple hospitality space into a reflection of its Scandinavian identity and creative DNA.

Lagom is not just a bar.
It is a **cultural layer**
added to the brand's
universe.



THE CONCEPT

EXPERIENCE AS VALUE

Lagom by Acne is an experiential brand extension that integrates **specialty café, a live creative atelier, and an exhibition space** within the flagship store.

It is **not** designed as a **commercial diversification**, but as a **natural evolution of the brand's cultural universe**.

The space combines:

- Nordic ritual (Fika culture)
- Visible artistic production
- Slow and contemplative permanence

The goal is not to increase immediate traffic, but to **deepen engagement and extend the time customers spend within the brand's ecosystem**.

Lagom transforms the retail space into a place to inhabit.

Acne Studios was founded as a creative collective. Fashion, art, photography, and publishing have always been interconnected within the brand.

- Acne Paper → cultural editorial platform
- Acne Gallery → contemporary patronage
- Creative Manifesto → responsibility and longevity

Lagom becomes the physical translation of this multidisciplinary identity.

It is not a forced expansion into a new sector. It is a continuation.

The brand does not change industry. It amplifies its essence.

HERITAGE
CULTURAL CAPITAL
CREATIVE INTEGRITY
EVOLUTION
ESSENCE AMPLIFICATION

COHERENCE WITH BRAND DNA



The choice of **Le Marais** is strategic.

It is one of the most **culturally active districts in Paris**: art galleries, concept stores, international creative audiences

Lagom requires an aligned environment — a place where the audience is already predisposed to hybrid experiences between fashion, art, and social space.

A brand extension of this nature can only function if the context speaks the same aesthetic language as the brand.

LOCATION STRATEGY

Paris

Acne Studios / Brand Extension



ESTIMATED COSTS

450 K to 700 K

BREAK-EVEN

Example scenario:

- Average ticket: €12
- Average customers/day: 180

Monthly revenue:

$$12 \times 180 \times 30 = \text{€}64,800$$

With average monthly costs of approx. €55,000, break-even is achievable with 160-170 customers per day.

Realistic figures for Le Marais flagship location.

Item	Description	Estimated €
Design & Concept	Interior design, architecture	80,000 - 150,000
Renovation & Furnishings	Custom materials, counter, tables	250,000 - 400,000
F&B Equipment	Coffee machines, refrigerators, ovens	60,000 - 120,000
Licenses & Permits	Food & beverage, health, safety	10,000 - 20,000
Technology	POS, QR menu, management system	8,000 - 15,000
Opening Marketing & PR	Launch event, press, influencers	30,000 - 70,000
Initial Inventory	Coffee, food, beverages, packaging	15,000 - 25,000

Item	Description	Monthly Estimate €
Staff	1 manager, 3-4 baristas, 1 host/event staff	18,000 - 28,000
Raw Materials	Coffee, bakery, beverages, snacks	6,000 - 10,000
Rent (allocated space)	Indoor space in flagship / Le Marais	12,000 - 20,000
Utilities	Electricity, water, internet	2,000 - 4,000
Ongoing Marketing	Events, social media, artist fees	2,000 - 5,000
Maintenance & Cleaning	Technical + hygiene	1,000 - 2,000

COMMUNICATION STRATEGY

"YOU'RE EARLY. PLEASE WAIT."

Objectives

Counter advertising over-noise
Transform waiting into experience
Let time speak, not the brand

Key Communication Principle

The brand occupies space without asking for attention.
Lagom does not interrupt.
It does not invite.
It does not explain.
It exists.
And those who are predisposed... will stop.

Why We Believe It Works

It is coherent with Lagom.
It turns waiting into value.
It fights spam without shouting.
It sparks curiosity and conversation.
It filters the audience through cultural affinity.



1 PRE-EXISTENCE DURATION: 10-14 DAYS

“Nothing is happening (yet)”

The window display is an empty space, defined by natural light and a single sentence engraved or applied on frosted glass:

YOU'RE EARLY. PLEASE WAIT.

No visible logo.

No date.

No call to action.

People do not know whether it has ended or has not yet begun.

This ambiguity is the first curatorial gesture.

Acne Studios / Brand Extension



window phrases are applied to:

- metro stations
- benches
- independent bookstore windows

“Lagom by Acne” appears discreetly, along with the opening date.

3

SILENT ADV IN THE CITY

2

MINIMAL, NEARLY INVISIBLE
DIGITAL TOUCHPOINTS

A discreet QR code at the bottom leads to an almost empty page.

Content:

- white screen
- ambient sounds
- one sentence changing every 24h

Among the few elements, a date appears the opening day **turning anticipation into curiosity.**





4 OPENING DAY





Those who choose to stay are given a simple design object: a limited-edition desk clock engraved with the phrase "This time matters".

A gesture that gives meaning to waiting and transforms it into a shared experience.

AN INVITATION TO REFLECT ON WAITING

In a world that constantly accelerates, where everything is immediate, announced and consumed in advance, Lagom by Acne proposes a different reflection on time. Waiting is no longer experienced as a lack or a loss, but as an active space, filled with meaning. Knowing how to wait becomes a conscious gesture — a choice that requires presence and attention.

Waiting is no longer the void before something happens, but an integral part of the experience itself. It is a moment in which time expands, creating a deeper relationship with space, with people and with what is taking place. In this sense, waiting does not mean being passive, but participating more authentically, embracing uncertainty as a necessary condition to give value to what arrives.

Lagom restores dignity to slow time, transforming waiting into a moment of reflection and involvement. Not everything must be immediate to be relevant: sometimes, it is precisely in time that the most meaningful experience is born.